

Rave Generation

PRESENTS

PMC60



USER MANUAL

1.0 Introduction

Welcome to Rave Generation: PMC60. PMC60 is a faithful digital emulation of the Lexicon PCM-60 Digital Reverberator, one of the most recognisable studio reverbs of the early 1980s. From compact rooms to bright plates, the original hardware became a staple because it delivered depth, density, and musical decay without getting in the way of a mix. PMC60 runs the original PCM-60 program code step by step, the way the unit's own processor did, so it is not a generic reverb algorithm or a set of impulse responses. Modern conveniences such as Pre-delay with tempo sync, RT Extend, Tone shaping, and reverb ducking are added around that core so the plugin is easy to use in contemporary sessions while preserving the character of the hardware.

1.1 Key features

Rave Generation: PMC60 combines original-program authenticity with a small set of carefully chosen workflow enhancements:

- **Original program code:** Runs the PCM-60's own Room and Plate programs, checked against recordings of real units for early reflections and decay times, plus Inverse, the reverse program from later PCM-60 units.
- **Twelve original program banks:** Room, Plate and Inverse each provide four Size variations (Small, Medium Small, Medium Large, Large), with four Reverb Time settings each.
- **Authentic native clocking:** Internal processing follows the original 24 kHz operating rate, with conversion to and from your DAW session rate.
- **Original bandwidth:** Flat to 10 kHz with a steep cut above it, as on the original unit.
- **Original contour switches:** Bass and Treble work like the buttons on the PCM-60 front panel.
- **RT Extend:** Pushes decay beyond the factory Reverb Time settings for longer ambient tails.
- **Pre-delay:** Adds up to 250 ms before the reverb input for cleaner separation between source and ambience.
- **Pre-delay Sync:** Locks the pre-delay time to the host tempo with musical note divisions from 1/2 down to 1/64T.
- **Tone:** A gentle tilt around 800 Hz that shapes the signal entering the reverb tank, from warm to bright, independent of the original Bass and Treble contour switches.
- **Ducking:** Automatically attenuates the reverb tail when the dry input is loud, keeping the mix clean without external sidechain processing.
- **Insert-friendly controls:** Mix, Input Level, and Output Level make PMC60 practical both on aux sends and directly on tracks.

2.0 User interface

2.1 Main controls

INPUT: Sets the level feeding the reverb engine from –20 dB to +6 dB. At 0 dB a full-scale signal stays clean; boosting it with long Reverb Time settings or a high RT Extend can drive the 16-bit signal path into audible clipping, much like the original hardware.

MIX: Blends dry and wet signal from 0% to 100%. At 100%, PMC60 behaves like a classic send-style reverb. Lower settings make it suitable for insert use.

OUTPUT: Applies final gain after dry/wet mixing, from –20 dB to +6 dB. Use it to match levels after changing programs or Mix settings.

BYPASS: Disables processing and passes audio through unchanged. Use this to compare the dry source with the active reverb setting.

2.2 Program selector

PLATE: Selects the Plate family. These programs are denser, brighter, and more diffuse, with a more open top end.

ROOM: Selects the Room family. These programs emphasise a more structured reflection pattern and a darker overall character.

INVERSE: Selects the Inverse program from later PCM-60 units. Each sound swells up and then cuts off, like reverb played backwards. Size sets the length of the swell; Reverb Time sets its shape, from a short burst at Short to a slow rise at Long.

Changing Program clears the reverb memory.

2.3 Size selector

SMALL: Tightest reverb field and shortest network lengths. Useful for small-room impressions, percussion, and subtle thickening.

MEDIUM SMALL: A versatile middle ground that works well on vocals, guitars, and general mix ambience.

MEDIUM LARGE: More spacious and open, with a wider early-reflection feel and longer internal delays.

LARGE: The biggest program size, suited to expansive rooms, plates, pads, and dramatic effect tails.

Each size sets the lengths of the program's delays and its built-in pre-delay. Changing Size clears the reverb memory.

2.4 Reverb Time selector

SHORT: Minimum factory decay for tight, quickly fading ambience.

MEDIUM SHORT: A balanced everyday setting for natural spaces and utility reverb.

MEDIUM LONG: A more sustained decay for featured reverb sounds.

LONG: Maximum factory decay within the selected Program and Size.

Changing Reverb Time does not clear the reverb memory, so it can be switched during playback.

2.5 Contour controls

BASS: With Bass engaged, low frequencies decay more slowly, giving the tail more weight and warmth.

TREBLE: With Treble engaged, high frequencies decay faster, so the tail darkens as it fades.

Bass and Treble are the PCM-60's own contour buttons; their exact effect differs between Room and Plate.

2.6 Additional controls

PRE-DELAY: Delays the signal feeding the reverb engine by up to 250 ms. This helps preserve the attack of vocals, snares, keys, and other transient-rich material before the reverb blooms.

RT EXTEND: Lengthens the decay beyond the selected Reverb Time in steps of 20%; the knob clicks into these steps. At 0% PMC60 behaves exactly like the original; at 100% the tail lasts up to about four times as long. Room reaches its longest at 80%. RT Extend has no effect on Inverse and is hidden while Inverse is selected.

PRE-DELAY SYNC: Click the metronome icon to lock the pre-delay to your DAW tempo. The knob switches from milliseconds to musical note divisions ranging from 1/2 down to 1/64T, including dotted and triplet values. Longer divisions that exceed the buffer length are clamped automatically.

TONE: Tilts the signal entering the reverb tank around 800 Hz. At 50% (centre) it is flat. Turning left makes it warmer, raising the lows and lowering the highs by up to 6 dB; turning right does the opposite. This is independent of the Bass and Treble contour switches, which shape the feedback and output instead.

DUCK AMOUNT: Sets how much the reverb tail is reduced when the dry input is loud. At 0% ducking is off. Higher values push the reverb further into the background during loud passages, letting it bloom back during quieter moments.

DUCK TIME: Controls how quickly the reverb returns to full level after the input drops. Lower values give a fast recovery; higher values keep the tail suppressed for longer.

3.0 Installation & troubleshooting

3.1 System requirements

Before installing Rave Generation: PMC60, ensure that your system meets the following requirements:

- Operating system: macOS 10.13 or later, or Windows 10 or later.
- Plugin formats: VST3 and AU.
- Processor: Intel Core i5 or equivalent.
- RAM: 4 GB minimum (8 GB or more recommended).
- Disk space: 100 MB free.

3.2 Installation process

- Download the installer from the official website or the platform where you purchased the plugin.
- Run the installer and follow the on-screen instructions.
- Launch your DAW and locate PMC60 in your plugin list.
- If prompted, activate the plugin using the licence key provided with your purchase.

3.3 Troubleshooting

- **PLUGIN NOT SHOWING IN YOUR DAW:** Check that the correct plugin path is enabled in your DAW's plugin manager, then rescan the plugin folders.
- **ACTIVATION ISSUES:** Verify your internet connection and enter the licence key exactly as provided.
- **REVERB CUTS OUT WHEN CHANGING PROGRAM OR SIZE:** This is normal. Those controls load a different ROM bank and clear the reverb memory.

For technical support, updates, and additional information: ravegeneration.io